

Proposal — Marketing and Communication Consulting Services

City of Detroit, Office of Contracting and Procurement · on behalf of the City Council · submitted by IEBC

Oct 5, 2026 · @marcus

Before you submit (internal — delete this section)

IEBC can compete on strategy, data and digital delivery, but the resumes don't show public-sector communications, media buying or PR work. Close that gap with a named team before submitting.

What the three files actually contain: all three are Mark Odom documents — the IEBC capabilities sheet, the executive resume, and a generic Marketing Manager cover letter. There are no resumes for other team members.

- ☐ **Name a team.** RFP evaluators score staffing. Add 2–3 people or partner firms with resumes: a media planner/buyer, a public-affairs or PR lead (press releases, media relations, crisis), and a creative/content lead (design, video, social). A Detroit-certified partner can also add local-business points.
- ☐ **Fix the inconsistencies.** The phone number is 661.466.9932 on two files and 206.850.5327 on the cover letter. The cover letter says "over 10 years" while the resume says 30+. Use one number and one story everywhere.
- ☐ **Don't attach the Marketing Manager cover letter.** It's written for a job application, not a proposal.
- ☐ **Back up every claim.** "50+ AI agents" and "22 hours/week saved per client" must be provable if asked. Name clients, or soften to "designed to."
- ☐ **Get the full RFP package** from the City's supplier portal: scope details, evaluation criteria, page limits, required forms, price form, insurance, due date and the questions deadline. This draft follows the description you pasted; the RFP's own outline controls.
- ☐ **City requirements:** supplier portal registration, City income and property tax clearances, insurance certificates, Covenant of Equal Opportunity and the other required affidavits, and Detroit-Based / Headquartered Business certification if IEBC qualifies (Detroit, MI 48219 is in the city).

- ☐ **Check the fees** in section 10 against your costs and what the City has paid before (ask the buyer for prior awards for similar work).
- ☐ **Fill every [bracket].**

RFP number: [] · Due date and time: [] · Buyer: [] · Questions due: [] · Pre-proposal meeting: []

1. Cover letter

[Date]

City of Detroit, Office of Contracting and Procurement Coleman A. Young Municipal Center, 2 Woodward Avenue (use the suite and address in the RFP) Detroit, MI 48226
Attn: [Buyer name], RFP [number]

Re: Marketing and Communication Consulting Services for the Detroit City Council

Dear [Buyer name]:

Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC), a Detroit company, submits this proposal to provide marketing and communication consulting services to the Detroit City Council for the three-year term in the RFP. That includes communications strategy, a media plan, and ongoing consulting.

We help Council reach more Detroiters with clear, timely information about its work: public hearings, formal sessions, the budget, and the decisions that affect each neighborhood. Every recommendation is measured, so Council can see what each channel and dollar delivered.

IEBC is led by Mark Odom, who has a B.S. in Marketing and more than 30 years in sales, marketing and business development. He has run strategic marketing and client programs for a national sales company with more than \$20 million in lifetime revenue, and he builds data, automation and AI systems for organizations. [Add one sentence on the partner firms and team members, section 8.]

This proposal is valid for [120] days. [Name, title] is authorized to bind IEBC and is the contact for this RFP at [one phone number] and [email].

Sincerely,

[Signature] Mark Odom, Founder & CEO Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC) Detroit, MI 48219

2. Executive summary

IEBC will give the Detroit City Council a three-year communications strategy and media plan, then help Council carry it out. The goal: more residents know what Council is deciding, how to take part, and what happened as a result.

What Council gets

- **A communications strategy and media plan in the first 16 weeks.** It's built from an audit of current channels, resident and stakeholder input, and data on how each neighborhood gets its news.
- **A media plan that fits Detroit.** It covers earned media (local press and radio), owned channels (Council web pages, social media, email and text updates, the City's cable channel), paid placements where they pay off, and community channels (block clubs, faith groups, libraries, recreation centers, community meetings).
- **Ongoing consulting:** message development, key-moment planning for the budget, public hearings and major votes, media training, and rapid support when an issue breaks.
- **Measurement Council can see:** a dashboard and a quarterly report on reach, engagement and participation by channel and district.

Why IEBC

- **Detroit-based, with a marketing foundation:** a B.S. in Marketing and three decades of strategic marketing, client programs and relationship building.
- **Data and technology built in.** IEBC builds dashboards, automated workflows and AI tools, so Council's communications become faster to produce and measurable.
- **A focused team, accountable to Council.** One lead, with specialist partners for media buying, public affairs and creative (section 8).

3. Our understanding of Council's needs

Council makes decisions that touch every neighborhood: the budget, land use, ordinances, contracts and public safety. Many residents only hear about those decisions after they're made. The work is to close that gap: tell residents early, in plain language, through the channels they already use, and make it easy to take part.

What that means in practice:

- **Many audiences.** Residents in seven districts, plus businesses, community organizations, faith leaders, block clubs, the press and other public bodies. Each needs a different message and channel.
- **Uneven access.** Some residents rely on social media and text. Others rely on radio, TV, print, word of mouth and community meetings. Many households have limited home internet, so a digital-only plan misses people.
- **Language access.** Key materials should be available in Spanish, Arabic and Bengali as well as English, in line with the City's language access practices. [Confirm the languages the RFP requires.]
- **Clear, nonpartisan information.** Communications about Council as an institution must stay factual and even-handed across all members.
- **Peak moments.** The budget cycle, major hearings and high-interest votes need planned campaigns, not one-off posts.
- **Proof of results.** Council and the public should see what the communications spending achieved.

[After reading the full RFP, add Council's stated goals and any current challenges it names, in its own words.]

4. Our approach

We start by listening and measuring, build the plan on what we learn, then run it in cycles. Each quarter's results shape the next quarter's plan.

1. Discover and audit.

- Interview Council members, staff and the City Clerk's and communications teams.
- Review every current channel: reach, frequency, tone, accessibility and language coverage.
- Gather resident input through short surveys (online, by text and on paper at community sites) and 4–6 listening sessions across districts.
- Map Detroit's media landscape: local newspapers and online newsrooms, TV, radio, community and ethnic media, and influential community voices.

2. Set strategy.

Define goals, audiences, core messages, voice and tone, and the measures of success. Council approves it before we plan any media.

3. Build the media plan.

- **Earned:** a press calendar, a story pipeline and relationships with reporters.

- **Owned:** web pages, social media, email and text updates, the City's cable channel, and plain-language explainers.
- **Paid:** targeted placements for peak moments, recommended only where they reach people owned and earned channels miss.
- **Community:** partners who carry messages door to door.

The plan includes a 12-month calendar and a budget by channel.

4. Carry it out and consult.

- Content and campaign support, message development, key-moment playbooks, media training and rapid-response guidance.
- Templates and AI-assisted tools so staff can produce accurate, consistent content faster. A person reviews everything before it's published.

5. **Measure and improve.** A live dashboard and quarterly reports, then an annual plan refresh.

5. Scope of services and deliverables

Each deliverable is reviewed and approved by Council's designated contact before it's final. Timing is counted from the notice to proceed. [Match these to the RFP's scope list item by item.]

Deliverable	What it includes	When
Communications audit	Current channels, reach and engagement, accessibility and language review, media landscape map, findings and quick wins	Week 6
Resident and stakeholder input report	Survey results, listening-session summaries by district, what residents want to know and how	Week 8
Communications strategy	Goals, audiences, core messages, voice and tone guide, success measures	Week 10
Media plan	Earned, owned, paid and community channels; 12-month calendar; budget by channel; key-moment campaigns	Week 16

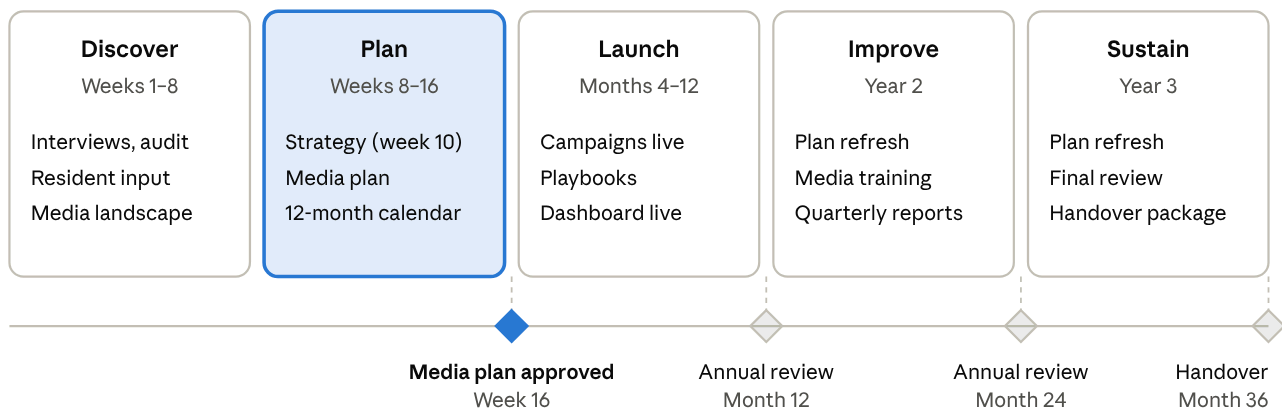
Deliverable	What it includes	When
Key-moment playbooks	Budget season, public hearings, major votes, emergencies: timelines, templates, roles	Week 20, then as needed
Ongoing consulting	Message and content guidance, press materials, event and hearing promotion, staff coaching, rapid response	Months 4-36
Media and spokesperson training	Sessions for members and staff on interviews and on-camera work	Twice a year
Dashboard and reports	Live dashboard; quarterly report; annual review with an updated plan	Quarterly; Months 12, 24, 36
Transition package	All plans, templates, contact lists and data handed over in usable form	End of term

Council owns all materials, data and contact lists created under this contract.

6. Three-year work plan

The strategy and media plan are approved by week 16, then reviewed every year

Three-year work plan for City Council, from the notice to proceed



work plan · 5 phases, 4 approval points

Council approves the strategy at week 10 and the media plan at week 16; after that, quarterly reports and an annual review keep the plan current. Phases are shown equal width, not to scale.

7. Team and qualifications

Mark Odom leads the engagement and is Council's single point of contact. Specialist partners cover media buying, public affairs and creative production.

Mark Odom — Engagement Lead (Founder & CEO, IEBC)

- **Education:** B.S. in Marketing, University of Hawaii.
- **Marketing and sales leadership:** CEO and owner of Northwest Ticket & Investment Company since 2001. He built and runs a national sales operation with more than \$20 million in lifetime revenue, including strategic marketing, the full client lifecycle and automated sales systems.
- **Data, automation and AI:** founder of IEBC (2025–present). He designs and builds dashboards, CRM pipelines, automated email and text programs, document systems and AI tools for organizations.
- **Stakeholder and executive relationships:** executive recruiter at Korn Ferry International (2001–2002), placing CEOs, CFOs and COOs for global organizations.
- **Accountability and compliance:** financial advisor and asset manager (1991–2001), managing more than \$100 million in client assets under Series 6, 7, 65 and insurance licenses.

Specialist team [name each person or firm and attach resumes]

Role	Responsibility	Name / firm	Detroit-based?
Media planner / buyer	Paid media plan, placements, negotiation, reporting	[]	[]
Public affairs / PR lead	Press relations, releases, media training, crisis communications	[]	[]
Creative and content lead	Design, video, social content, plain-language writing	[]	[]
Community engagement lead	Listening sessions, community partners, outreach	[]	[]

Role	Responsibility	Name / firm	Detroit-based?
Translation partner	Spanish, Arabic and Bengali materials	[]	[]

8. Relevant experience and capabilities

IEBC brings two things most communications firms don't combine: marketing strategy, and the ability to build the tools that run and measure it.

- **Strategic marketing at scale (Northwest Ticket & Investment Company, 2001–present).** Planned and ran marketing and client programs for a national sales operation with more than \$20 million in lifetime revenue. [Add 1–2 specific campaigns: audience, channels, result.]
- **Automated outreach programs (IEBC).** Built multi-channel email and text programs, contact lists, scoring and follow-up sequences. The same approach can keep residents informed about hearings and deadlines, with opt-in and easy unsubscribe.
- **Dashboards and reporting (IEBC).** Built real-time dashboards and reporting systems. Council would get one place to see reach, engagement and participation by channel and district.
- **Content and document systems (IEBC).** Built template-driven content and document tools that produce consistent, accurate materials quickly. For Council: notices, explainers and translated versions from one approved source.
- **Relationship building (Korn Ferry International).** Executive search across medical device, telecom and financial organizations, built on trust with senior decision-makers.

Partner experience [add 2–3 public-sector or civic communications projects from the partner firms: client, scope, dates, result. This is the area evaluators will weigh most.]

9. Measurement, reporting and accountability

Council sees results every quarter, and targets are set with Council in the strategy phase (week 10) from the audit's baseline.

Measure	How it's tracked	Reported
Reach by channel and district	Social, web, email/text and media analytics; press coverage log	Dashboard, quarterly

Measure	How it's tracked	Reported
Engagement	Opens, clicks, shares, video views, questions received	Dashboard, quarterly
Participation	Public-comment sign-ups, hearing and meeting attendance, survey responses	Quarterly
Earned media	Stories placed, outlets, tone, Council messages carried	Monthly log
Language and accessibility	Share of key materials in Spanish, Arabic and Bengali; accessibility checks	Quarterly
Resident awareness	Short annual survey on how residents hear about Council	Annually
Paid media value	Cost per resident reached, by placement	After each campaign

Accountability: a 30-minute weekly check-in with Council's contact, a monthly activity report with hours and deliverables, and a quarterly review with recommendations. If a measure falls short two quarters in a row, we present a written correction plan.

10. Fee proposal

The three-year professional fee is **\$293,000**: a fixed fee for the strategy and media plan, then a monthly consulting retainer. Media buys and outside costs are passed through at cost, only with Council's written approval. [Draft figures — confirm against your costs and partner quotes, and enter them on the City's price form if one is provided.]

Item	Basis	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Discovery, audit and resident input (weeks 1-8)	Fixed fee	\$19,000	—	—
Strategy and media plan (weeks 8-16)	Fixed fee	\$19,000	—	—
Ongoing consulting retainer, up to 50 hours a month	\$7,500 a month (months 5-36)	\$60,000	\$90,000	\$90,000

Item	Basis	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Media and spokesperson training	\$2,500 a session, 2 a year	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$5,000
Total professional fees		\$103,000	\$95,000	\$95,000

Hourly rates for approved work beyond the retainer: engagement lead \$150; specialists (media, public affairs, creative) \$110; production support \$85.

Pass-through costs: paid media, printing, translation, venues and survey incentives, billed at actual cost with receipts and no markup, each approved in writing beforehand. The media plan recommends a paid-media budget for Council to decide on.

Billing: monthly invoices with hours, deliverables and receipts, on the City's standard payment terms. Unused retainer hours don't roll over; the activity report shows how each month's hours were used.

11. References, required forms and signature

References — three clients who can speak to marketing, communications or outreach work by IEBC or its partners. List only people who have agreed to be called.

Organization and contact	Phone and email	Work performed	Dates
[]	[]	[]	[]
[]	[]	[]	[]
[]	[]	[]	[]

Required forms and attachments — check against the RFP's list; the City's list controls.

- ☐ Signed proposal form and price form
- ☐ Supplier portal registration current
- ☐ City of Detroit income tax and property tax clearances
- ☐ Certificates of insurance (City of Detroit as additional insured)
- ☐ Covenant of Equal Opportunity, hiring policy compliance and the City's required disclosure affidavits
- ☐ Detroit-Based / Headquartered Business certificate, if held

- ☐ Resumes for every named team member and partner
- ☐ Partner (subcontractor) list and their certifications
- ☐ W-9
- ☐ Signed addenda acknowledgments, if any

Signature

By signing, the Respondent confirms that this proposal is true and complete and accepts the RFP's terms and conditions.

Authorized signature: _____

Name and title: Mark Odom, Founder & CEO

Company: Integrated Efficiency Business Consultants (IEBC)

Date: []